D.J. PARIS

AGENT USE JUST HIT A 40-YEAR HIGH.

Even with AI tools everywhere this year.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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NINETY PERCENT OF BUYERS USED AN AGENT THIS YEAR. THE HIGHEST SHARE NAR HAS MEASURED IN FOUR DECADES.

Only 1% of those buyers found that agent by searching with AI.

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IT WAS NEVER ABOUT HAVING MORE INFORMATION.

NAR's own deputy chief economist, Jessica Lautz, said the new high "might seem counterintuitive" given how much a buyer can look up on their own, but that information "can be misleading without proper context" from an agent. The survey backs that up: four in ten buyers found their agent through a friend, neighbor, or relative, and 63% of sellers hired someone they had worked with before or someone who referred them. Reputation, cited by 31% of sellers, beat every other reason to hire.

WHAT TO DO WITH THAT THIS MONTH:

1 **Ask for the referral out loud, at every closing.**
Four in ten buyers found their last agent that way, and most agents never ask directly.

2 **Put your reputation where a seller can find it in ten seconds.**
Reviews and past sales, not just a bio nobody reads.

3 **Treat your past-client list as your lead source, not your mailing list.**
63% of sellers hired someone they had already worked with or been referred to.

THE TAKEAWAY

HERE'S WHAT YOU DO NOW.

Text five past clients today and ask them directly for an introduction. The algorithm didn't hit a 40-year high. Your reputation did.

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